

Your Startup, Built on AWS

Everything you need to start building



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Agenda

Three parts in about an hour, then open office hours until 2:00 PM ET

1 THE IDEA

RAVI

What you're building this weekend

- The goal: a working agent by Saturday
- Start small, then add what it needs



2 LIVE IN THE WORKSHOP

NANDHINI

Hands-on, on your own screen

- Workshop setup: get into your team's account
- Toolbox: your IDE and AWS services
- Your first agent, built live



3 GO BUILD

RAVI

Everything you need before you start

- From idea to working solution
- Before you build: six things to know
- How to win Best Use of AWS
- Getting help

THEN, UNTIL 2:00 Open office hours: breakout rooms with an AWS mentor for your team's specific questions.



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What you're building this weekend

A working agent, built with the services that fit your idea

YOUR ACCOUNT COMES READY Leading AI models · everything you need to build and run agents · 30+ AWS services for data, analytics and security

1 START SMALL

Get a model calling one function you wrote

Make that work end to end before anything else



2 ADD WHAT IT NEEDS

Knowledge, memory, a front end or a data pipeline

Only what your idea actually needs, nothing for show



3 KNOW YOUR WHY

Let your startup's problem drive every choice

Judges will ask why you built it this way

Next: Nandhini takes you live into the workshop. Have your team access code ready.



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Live workshop walkthrough



With Nandhini Balakrishnan, live in Workshop Studio

From idea to working solution

A menu, not a blueprint



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Before you build: six things to know

Each one saves you hours

1

Stay in us-east-1

N. Virginia only. Access denied? Check your region first.

2

HARD LIMIT

Use Bedrock for models

GPU instances are blocked in these accounts.

3

About 1 Bedrock call per second

Add a short pause in any loop, or you'll be throttled mid-demo.

4

Made-up data only

Never personal or real financial data.

5

Keep S3 buckets private

No public buckets, ever.

6

HARD LIMIT

Save as you go

Push to your own GitHub or download. Accounts are deleted after the event.



How to win Best Use of AWS

Listed in order of what matters most

1

USE AWS WELL

Pick each service because your idea needs it, not to fill a list

2

BUILD IT RIGHT

No hard-coded keys, tight permissions, graceful errors, a right-sized model

3

SOLVE A REAL PROBLEM

One an advisor or investor would actually want fixed

4

MAKE IT WORK

Show it running live, not just on slides

5

TELL THE STORY

Who it helps, why it matters, and why you built it this way

THE BOTTOM LINE A small agent that works, and that you can explain, beats an ambitious one that doesn't.



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Getting help

You're not on your own this weekend

UNTIL 2:00

Open office hours

Stay on after this session

We'll pull your team into a breakout room for your specific questions

TONIGHT

Book an AWS mentor

Fri 4:00-5:00 PM and 8:00-9:00 PM ET

Grab a slot on the sign-up sheet

ANYTIME

Learn from the source

How-to library:
catalog.workshops.aws/genai-hackathon

Working code: <https://github.com/strands-agents/samples>

Going further: [AgentCore samples](#)

SATURDAY When you wrap up, take 2 minutes for the AWS workshop survey: click Share feedback in the workshop's left menu

Now go build.



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Thank you!

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